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Ad Fatigue

The Silent Killer Of ROAS
(return on ad spend)

Ad Fatigue Definition:

When a set of video or image ad creatives run for too long, the ad channel starts to punish you by lowering result volume and increasing cost per result

The ad channels are designed to do this so users don’t get targeted with the same ads day in and day out

You know ad fatigue is happening because over the course of 72 hours your result volume continues to drop, and your cost per result continues to increase

And unfortunately the problem only gets worse as time goes on…

I’m now going to show you a practical example of ad fatigue happening so you understand

This client is spending $7,500/day on a campaign, which upon launch resulted in 63 calls ($119/cost per call)

Filters Starting Mar 16, 2022 Ending Mar 16, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	1156	892
Survey	233	198
Schedule	93	84
Confirmation	75	63

This is day 2 of spending $7,500/day on a campaign, which resulted in 61 calls ($122/cost per call)

Filters Starting Mar 17, 2022 Ending Mar 17, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	1317	1058
Survey	229	187
Schedule	97	86
Confirmation	67	61

This is day 7 of spending $7,500/day on a fatigued campaign, which resulted in 37 calls ($202/cost per call)

Filters Starting Mar 23, 2022 Ending Mar 23, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	1680	1459
Survey	139	113
Schedule	57	48
Confirmation	43	37

Just 1 week after launch and spending $7,500 daily we can see a spike of almost 90% in additional cost per call and almost half the result volume of the day 1 and 2 results…

We told this client (as we tell every client) what ad fatigue is and how it works

The only way to stay ahead of ad fatigue is by having a creative surplus of videos and images on stand by to swap in place of old fatigued ads when the issue arrises

Unfortunately this client does what most clients do… and they push off getting new creative to us

When then lowers the efficiency of their dollars being spent

It’s like having a car that is 50 mpg (miles per gallon) one day, and 7 days later it’s 25 mpg and trending to get worse

And the only way to prevent is to have fresh tires on stand by to replace the old tires causing the loss in fuel efficiency

Most clients don’t keep a surplus of ad creatives on file with us therefore we are constantly having to press them AFTER the ad fatigue issue has already presented itself

The worst time to prevent a problem is after the problem has already become an issue

It'd be like needed a glass breaker for a window in case your car flies into water after you're already sinking in the water stuck in the car, the prep matters to how stressful overcoming the problem gets

Back to the story…

This client didn’t get us new ads for one month after the launch of those ads that fatigued, let’s see what happened over the 4 weeks…

This is day 14 of spending $7,500/day on a fatigued campaign, which resulted in 25 calls ($300/cost per call)

Filters Starting Mar 30, 2022 Ending Mar 30, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	1665	1487
Survey	78	57
Schedule	26	21
Confirmation	34	25

This is day 21 of spending $7,500/day on a fatigued campaign, which resulted in 21 calls ($357/cost per call)

Filters Starting Apr 6, 2022 Ending Apr 6, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	2366	2069
Survey	59	46
Schedule	60	56
Confirmation	27	21

This is day 30 of spending $7,500/day on a fatigued campaign, which resulted in 20 calls ($375/cost per call)

Filters Starting Apr 13, 2022 Ending Apr 13, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	2425	2200
Survey	0	0
Schedule	78	62
Confirmation	23	20

This client then shot new ads after learning the hard way what ad fatigue was… but it took 4 days to edit after the client shot them

This is day 37 of spending $7,500/day on a fatigued campaign, which resulted in 14 calls ($535/cost per call)

Filters Starting Apr 18, 2022 Ending Apr 18, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	3598	3304
Survey	2	2
Schedule	52	39
Confirmation	21	14

We finally got the new ads, it only took two new videos to relaunch the campaign, and we kept 3 others in reserve for when the next fatigue occurs, let’s see what happens to the result volume and cost per result

This is day 1 of spending $7,500/day on a new campaign, which resulted in 78 calls ($96/cost per call)

Filters Starting Apr 19, 2022 Ending Apr 19, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	2847	2551
Survey	2	2
Schedule	258	234
Confirmation	90	78

This is day 2 of spending $7,500/day on a new campaign, which resulted in 281 calls ($26/cost per call)

Filters Starting Apr 20, 2022 Ending Apr 20, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	3692	3077
Survey	4	2
Schedule	855	774
Confirmation	292	281

This is halfway through day 3 of spending $7,500/day on a new campaign, which resulted in 138 calls so far ($54/cost per call)

Filters Starting Apr 21, 2022 Ending Apr 21, 2022

	Page Views	
	All	Uniques
Optin	2038	1623
Survey	0	0
Schedule	450	372
Confirmation	148	138

Thankfully overcoming ad fatigue is simple

All we have to do is duplicate the campaign that has fatigued ads, go to the ad level of the newly duplicated campaign, and change the old video or image ads for new video or image ads

We then wait for the newly duplicated campaign with fresh ads to get approved, and then we shut off the old campaign with the old fatigued ads

And like magic, the new campaigns performance goes back to result volume and cost per result levels pre fatigue

Sometimes the new ads perform better than the old ads as we saw in this example together today

Why not shut off a fatigued campaign?

Or lower the spend?

Because any calls are better than no calls when the client doesn’t have new creatives for us

And this particular client has an AOV (average order value) of $75,000 so they can tolerate the higher cost per call

Some businesses arguably can’t do that and would be forced to shut down their ads waiting until new ads get shot and edited

Ad fatigue is real…

Always have videos and images in a creative surplus reserve to ensure you don’t deal with ad fatigue longer than 72 hours.

It makes all the difference to your ROAS (return on ad spend)